MC 501 Sampling Plan and Pilot, 20 to 30 items rubric

75 points. Due Monday, November 9, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 75. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Length: 1,000 to 1,600 words across the plan and the pilot write-up, plus 20 to 30 coded items. Word counts cover your own writing, not the title, headings, tables, references, figure captions, code, or output, and writing more than the range never costs points. Scores on work that shows effort are adjusted with the course's curve: your final percentage is 25 percent plus 75 percent of your rubric percentage, so 50 of 100 on the rubric becomes 62.5. Work at two-thirds or more of the minimum length counts as showing effort. Attempts are unlimited, so you can revise an early submission right up to the deadline.

- The plan rows total 25, size justification 15, pilot data and the reliability computation 20, and edge cases and revisions 15.

Sampling Plan and Pilot, 20 to 30 items, 75 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Plan: population, frame, and the gap 12 points	**12 points.** Defines the population, names the frame you draw from, and states where the two differ instead of assuming they match.	**9 to 11 points.** Population and frame defined, with the gap named in a phrase but not located.	**6 to 8 points.** The frame is treated as the population.	**0 to 5 points.** Missing.
Plan: method 13 points	**13 points.** Names and justifies the method, and says what it lets you estimate and what it does not.	**10 to 12 points.** Named and justified, without what it can and cannot estimate.	**7 to 9 points.** Named with no reason.	**0 to 6 points.** Missing.
Size: the justification 10 points	**10 points.** Names which of the three justifications you use (an effect size from a named study, a smallest effect worth detecting argued from its consequences, or a resource limit stated as one and paired with a sensitivity analysis) and carries it through.	**8 to 9 points.** Names one, but it is incomplete; a resource limit with no sensitivity analysis is the usual gap.	**5 to 7 points.** Justified by convention ("eighty percent power") instead of by argument.	**0 to 4 points.** No justification.
Size: the time calibration 5 points	**5 points.** Your measured rate from a timed twenty-item trial, the corpus size it produces, and the nearest row of the sizing table.	**4 points.** The rate is measured, but one of the other two is missing.	**3 points.** The rate is copied from the table instead of timed.	**0 to 2 points.** Missing.
Pilot: items coded 8 points	**8 points.** Twenty to thirty items coded and submitted as data.	**6 to 7 points.** Coded and submitted, but fewer than twenty.	**4 to 5 points.** Coding described, but no data file.	**0 to 3 points.** No pilot coding.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Pilot: the stability figure 12 points	**12 points.** A stability figure from re-coding your own pilot items after at least 48 hours, computed by code you submit, and described as stability, not agreement between coders.	**9 to 11 points.** Computed and submitted, but the gap or the code is missing, or it is called agreement between coders.	**6 to 8 points.** A figure with no code behind it, or percent agreement alone.	**0 to 5 points.** None.
Edge cases 6 points	**6 points.** Every edge case, with the decision made and the rule added.	**5 points.** Listed with decisions, but some rules were not added.	**3 to 4 points.** Listed without the decisions.	**0 to 2 points.** None listed.
Revisions the pilot forced 6 points	**6 points.** The before and after wording for each change the pilot forced.	**5 points.** Changes described, without the before and after.	**3 to 4 points.** Reports that nothing changed. A pilot that changes nothing was usually too easy.	**0 to 2 points.** Missing.
What the pilot says about the full run 3 points	**3 points.** One paragraph on how long the full run will take and what you will change.	**2 points.** One of the two.	**1 point.** Mentioned without a time or a change.	**0 points.** Missing.

How big should your corpus be

The coding-time budget below is a resource constraint, and it is the size justification most of you will use.

Size your corpus by coding time, not by item count, because a chat message and a news article are not the same amount of work. Budget two to four hours of coding in total: roughly the first third building and revising the codebook on a small subset, and the remaining two thirds applying the frozen codebook to the full corpus.

The baseline is 250 chat messages at 45 seconds each, which is three and an eighth hours. Every other row is scaled from that one, holding the time constant and changing only the seconds one unit costs.

Corpus size by unit of analysis

Unit of analysis	Typical length	Seconds each	Corpus target
Chat or stream messages, short comments	under 20 words	45	250
Short posts, captions, headlines	20 to 60 words	75	150
Survey open ends, product or media reviews	50 to 150 words	110	100
Long comments, forum posts, letters	150 to 400 words	220	50
News articles, blog posts, press releases	400 to 1,200 words	450	25
Video or audio coded in one-minute slices	one minute	180	60 minutes of material
Images, thumbnails, advertisements	not applicable	90	125

Calibrate against your own rate, not the table: code twenty items, time it, divide, and use that number.

Fifty coded units is the floor. If your rate puts you under fifty, do not shrink the corpus further; change the unit of analysis instead and code paragraphs or sentences inside documents.

More variables cost more time. These rates assume three to six coded variables per unit; ten variables roughly halves the rate, so either halve the corpus or cut variables, and say in the plan which you chose.

The table is a planning estimate, not your final number. Your exact sample size gets set with me once your topic and questions are in, and it is confirmed at the Research Proposal. Until then, plan from the table and say in the document which row you used.

Before you submit

Sampling Check turns your own coding rate and available hours into the corpus size they support, sizes the reliability subset from your rarest category, and reports the smallest effect a sample that size could detect. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.

Agreement Check takes your two coding passes as two columns and returns percent agreement, the statistic with its threshold, and the items the two passes disagree on. Set it to one coder, two passes. Or enter both passes in the R Companion's Reliability grid in VS Code, which saves them as a CSV and writes the `v2v::reliability()` call into your script; that call counts as code you submit. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.